String Quartet No. 1

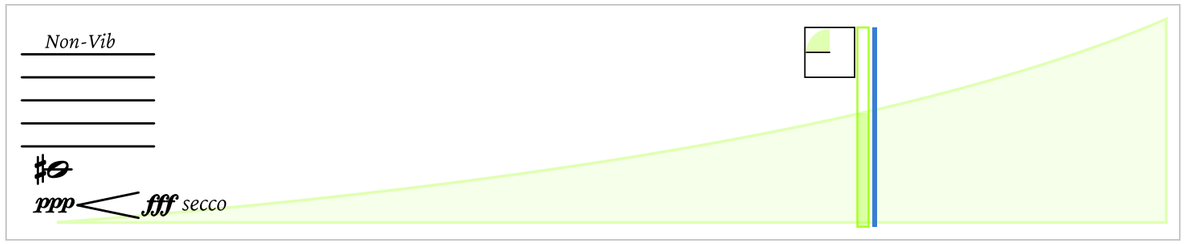
Justin Yang

Performance Instructions

String Quartet No. 1 — Justin Yang

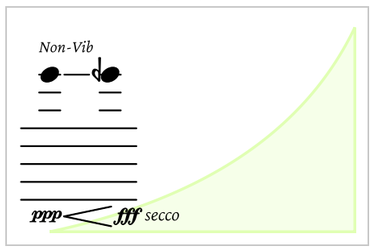
The score for *String Quartet No. 1* is a computer-animated score, served from the cloud and displayed in a web browser, like an online video game.

Curve-Based Crescendo



Play the crescendo from dynamic 1 to dynamic 2. The bottom of the curve corresponds to the starting dynamic, the top to the ending dynamic. The contour of the curve determines how the crescendo grows over time.

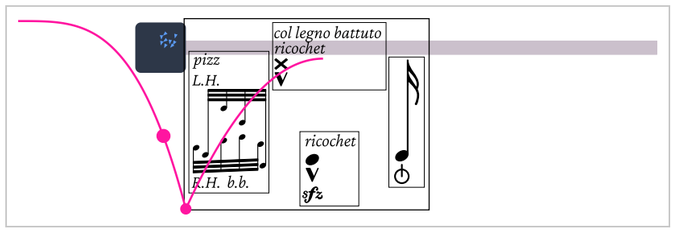
A **curve follower** gives your real-time position in the curve. An **animated dial** counts down for the duration of the curve.

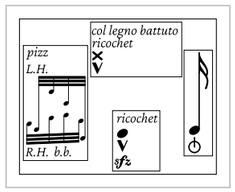


Curve-Based Crescendos with Glissandos

The curve describes the crescendo. The glissando should be made over the duration of the curve. You can choose to glissando with the curve (or inverse), or you can do a linear glissando over the duration of the curve.

Like-Walking-on-a-Carpet-of-Twigs





Motive Cell

Play any of these motives during the designated duration. All are open pitch. Quarter-tone or greater resolution is encouraged. The pizzicato motive is a two-handed pizzicato played like a grace-note figure in "one attack." You can finger pitches or a double stop with your left hand, and with the remaining fingers, pluck. The right hand will pluck behind the bridge. The rest of the notation is self-explanatory.



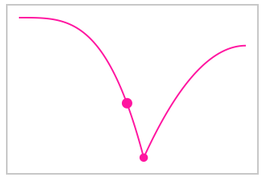
Line Wedge

Play for the duration of the line. The thickness of the line represents density. The thickest line (maximum density) takes up about the top third of the track.



Ensemble Texture Indicator

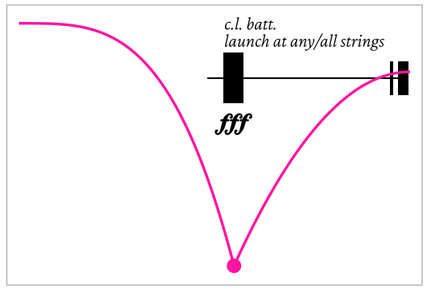
This indicates a "flocking" ensemble texture. Play immediately after another player, or you can try to anticipate and play immediately before another player. This leads to a clustering of motives throughout the ensemble. The line wedge refers to the density of articulations, so the first line shown here is relatively sparse.

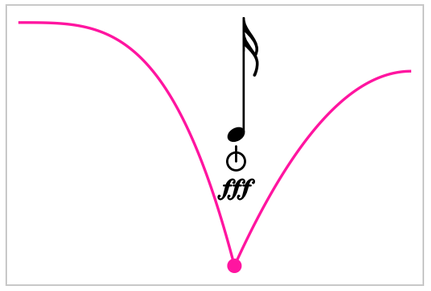


Gravitational Conductors (bouncing ball)

If these appear, play one of the motives as conducted using the ictus suggested by the animation.

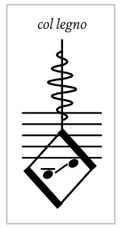
Conducted Articulation





Play the indicated articulation using the ictus suggested by the gravitational conductor animation. If no pitch is indicated, you can use open pitch. Quarter-tone resolution or greater is encouraged.

Harmonic Flutter



A rapid, fluttering sound with continuously changing harmonics.

Left hand: Move continuously on the fingerboard in the range indicated by the notated pitches. Try to find the highest harmonics you can sustain. Hold briefly, then continue the search.

Right hand: Use a combination of jeté, bow pressure, and bow speed to create and sustain as rapid a flutter as possible.

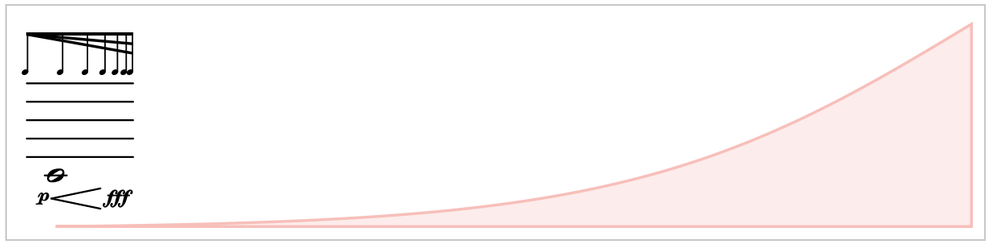
Harmonic Tremolo



Use the same left-hand technique as above and play an unmeasured tremolo.

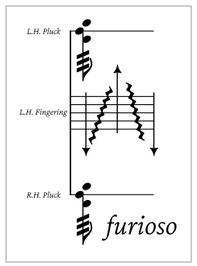
Performance Instructions *continued*

Accelerando / Decelerando



The curve determines the rate and shape of acceleration or deceleration over time.

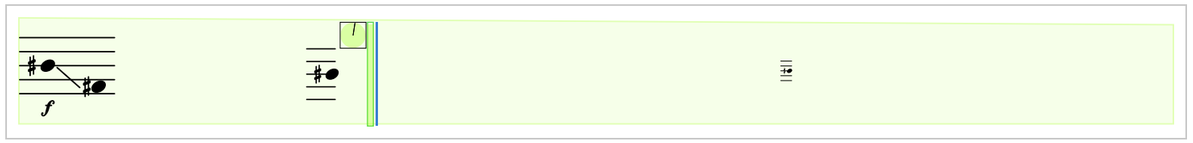
Pizzicato Storm



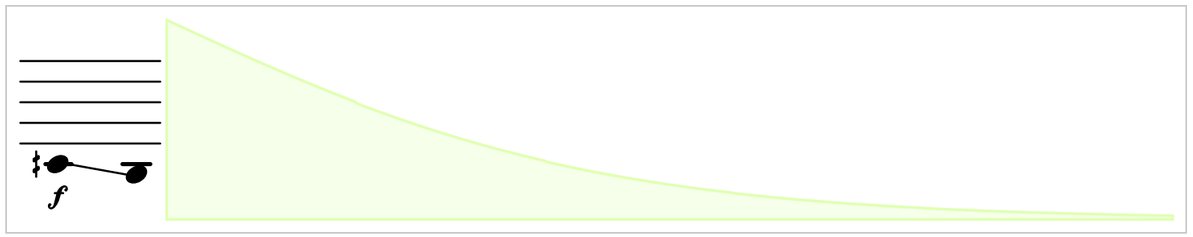
Left hand moves chaotically across the fingerboard and all strings. Use as many fingers from both hands to pluck a dense mass of pizzicato, like a hailstorm.

Acoustic Beating

In this section, the ensemble plays a variety of glissandos and long tones to generate acoustic beating.



The viola plays the anchor tone, which is a long, slow glissando. The scroll bar has a pitch tracking system that will display the approximate pitch you are at with quarter-tone resolution. Small, static pitches can be found throughout the curve which indicate when you've reached that pitch.

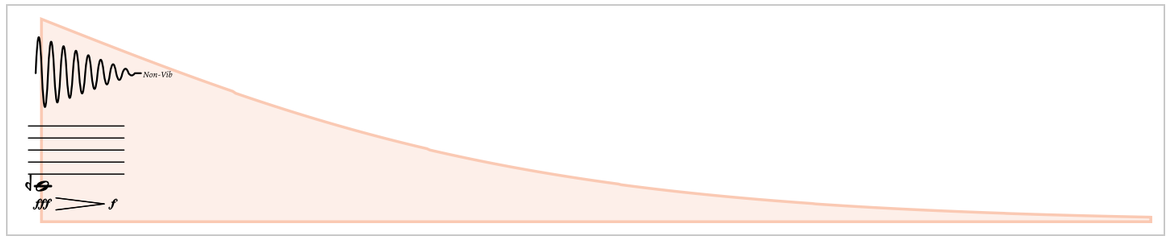


In this section, the curve describes the glissando. The curve defines the rate and shape of pitch change over time.

Dynamics

Adjust the dynamics throughout this section so that the acoustic beating effect is as rich as possible.

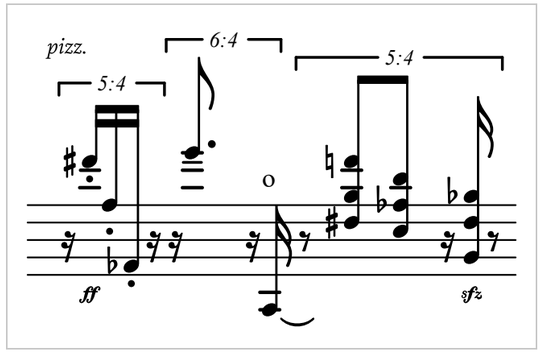
Vibrato Speed

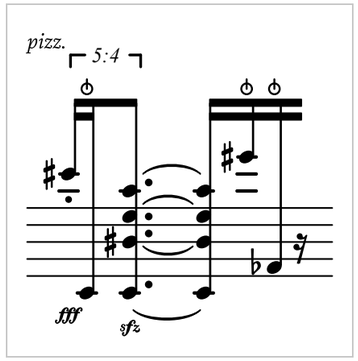


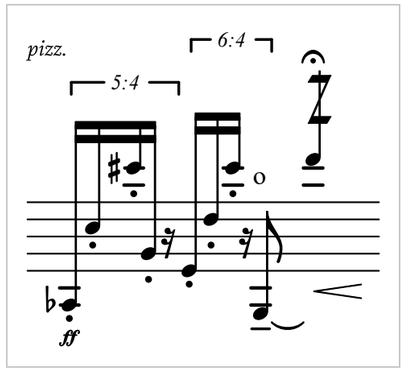
The curve describes vibrato speed.

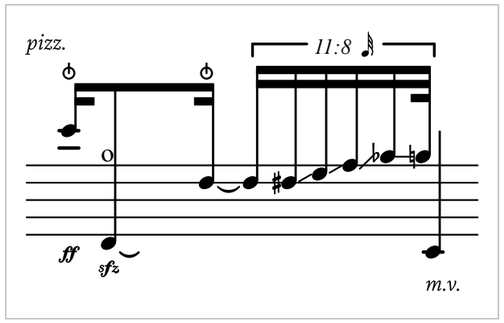
Notation Fragments

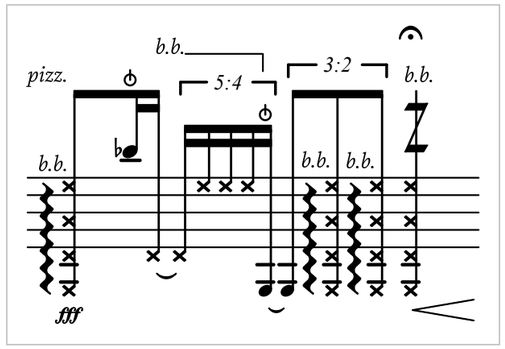
Play the fragment as written at your own tempo. The gravitational conductor indicates when to begin the fragment. If you have not finished playing the entire fragment by the time another event comes, abandon the fragment and play the next event on time.

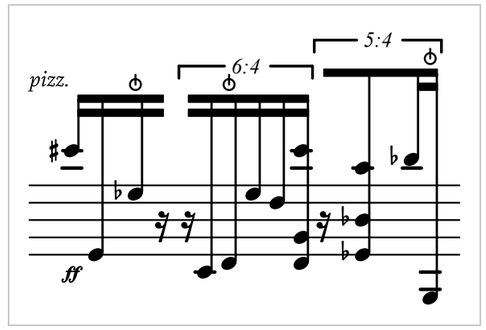


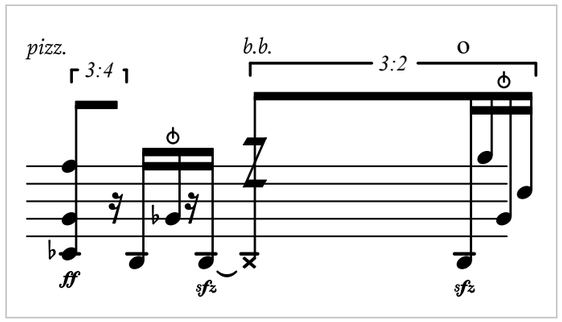


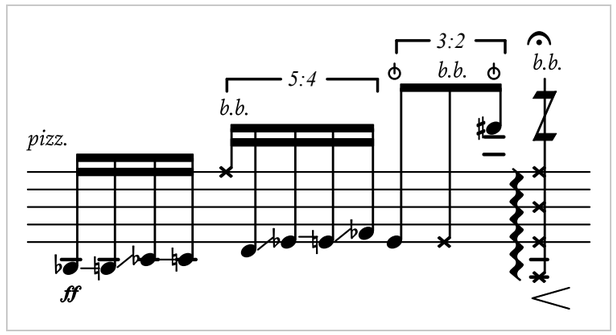




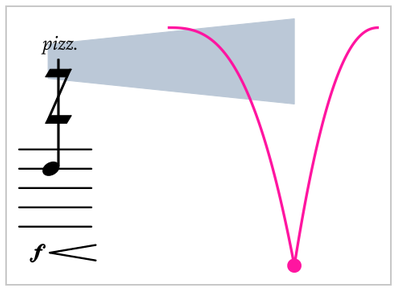


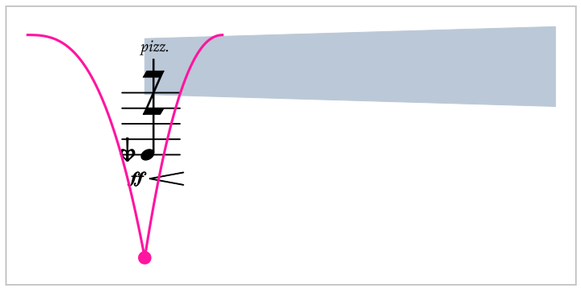






Unmeasured Pizzicato Tremolo



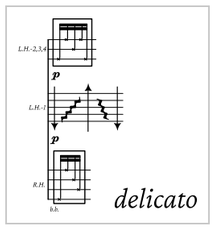


The gray line wedge indicates intensity and speed of the tremolo. The gravitational conductor indicates a begin attack or an end attack.

If the notation and line wedge is before the gravitational conductor, begin the tremolo at the beginning of the line wedge and end abruptly at the impact of the gravitational conductor in a manner suggested by the gravitational conductor ball impact.

If the gravitational conductor is at the beginning, begin the tremolo in a manner suggested by the gravitational conductor.

Quiet Two-Hand Pizzicato Cluster



The left hand technique: finger the third or fourth string and use the fleshy part of the index finger to mute the higher strings, then strum with one of your remaining fingers. The right hand will play one or several of the strings behind the bridge. Play both hands simultaneously in an irregular cluster. The cluster duration and shape can vary throughout the motive.

The line wedge indicates density of articulation, but the motive should remain quiet throughout the section.

violin I

violin II

viola

cello

Non-Vib

ppp *fff* *secco*

col legno battuto
ricochet

pizz
L.H.

R.H. *b.b.*

ricochet

sfz

max. pressure *ord.*

c.l. batt.
launch at any/all strings

15

20

Non-Vib

ppp fff secco

col legno battuto
ricochet

pizz
L.H.

R.H. b.b.

ricochet

25

30

c.l.b. jeté

max. pressure ord.

30

35

c.l.b. jeté

f

40

45

col legno







60

55

50

65

70

secco

secco

secco

secco

70

75

secco

secco

secco

secco

fff

p fff

fff

p fff

80

85

90

Non-Vib

secco

95

100

105

110

Non-Vib

ppp fff secco

ff

L.H. Pluck

L.H. Fingering

R.H. Pluck

furioso

110

115

secco

secco

secco

secco

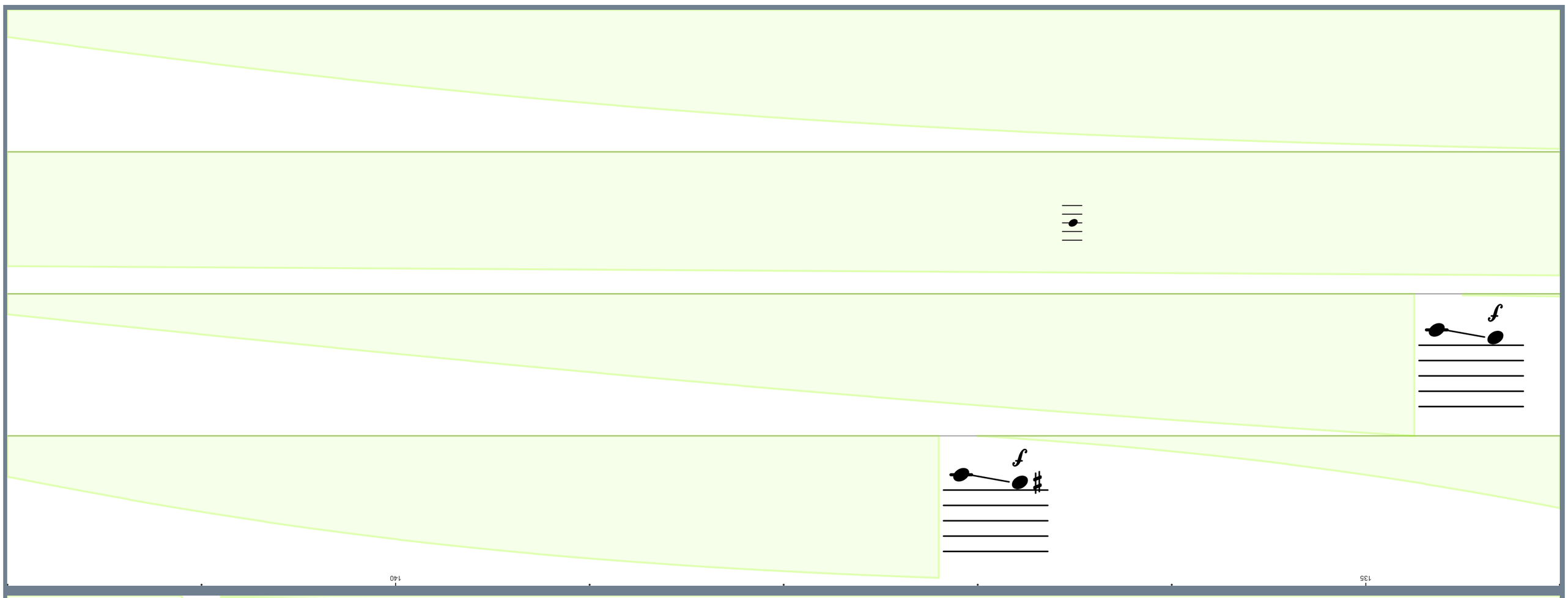
120

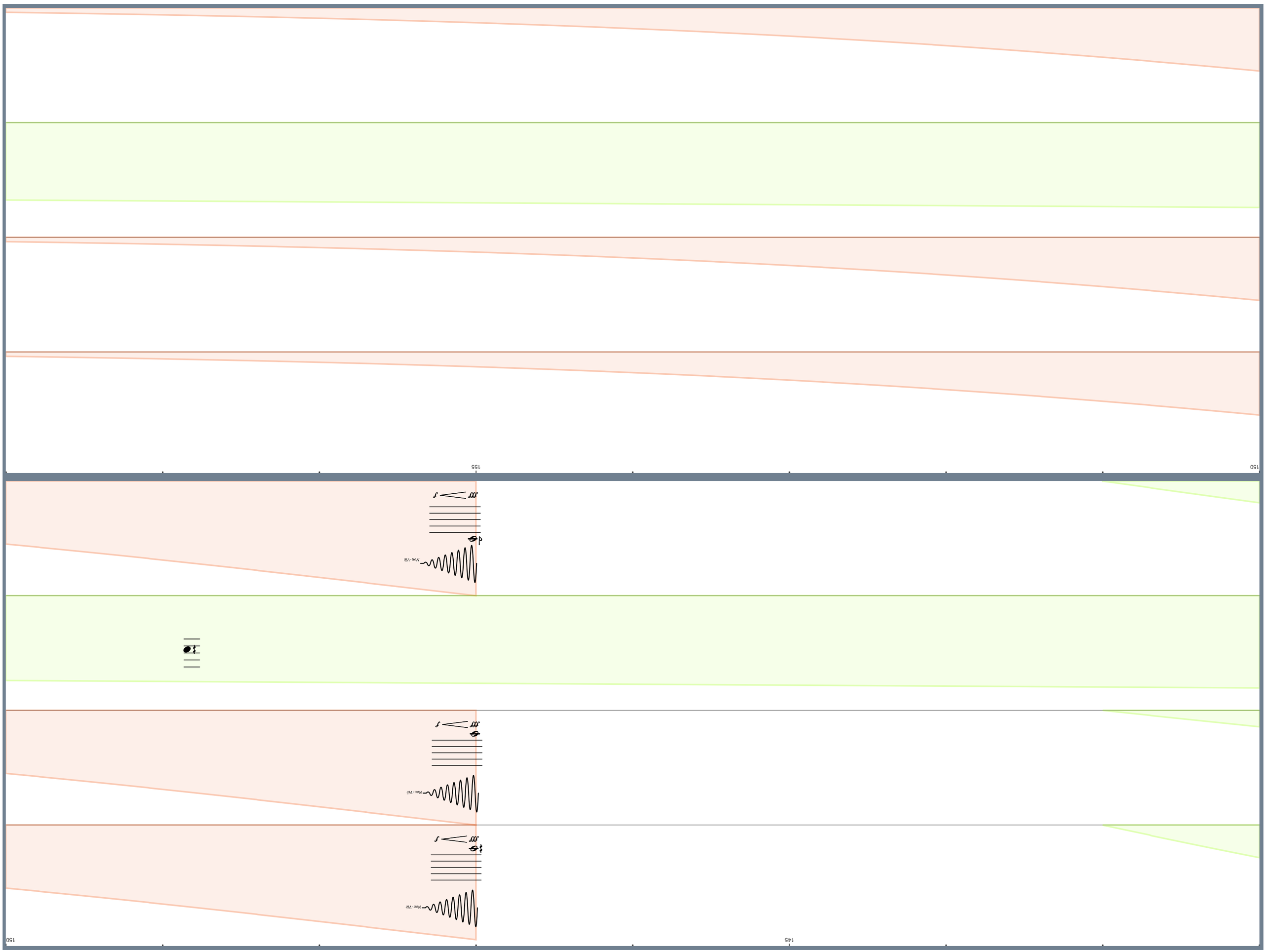
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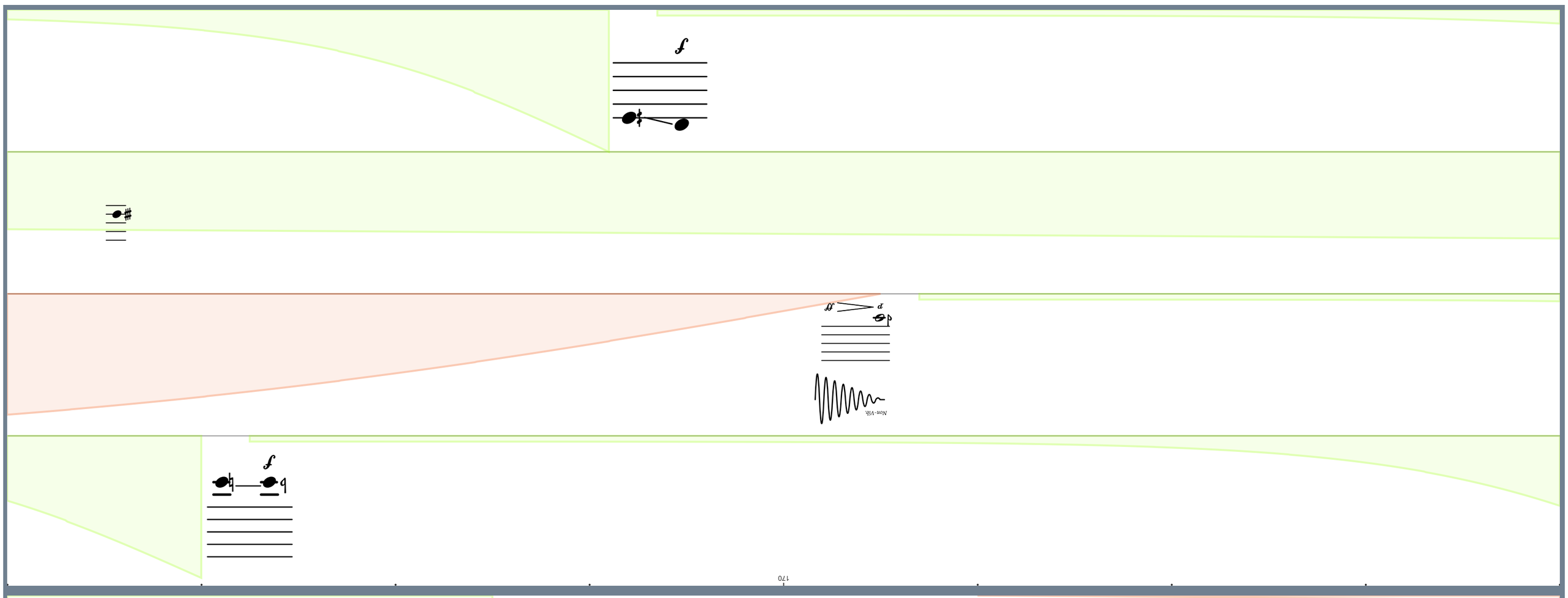
f

f

f


f
f
f
f
f
f
140
135
130


155
150
Non-Vib
Non-Vib
Non-Vib
Non-Vib
145
150


f
Nor.-Vlc.
p
ff
f
f
f
f
170
165
160

175

180

f

f

Non-Vib.

p ff

185

190

Non-Vib

fff f

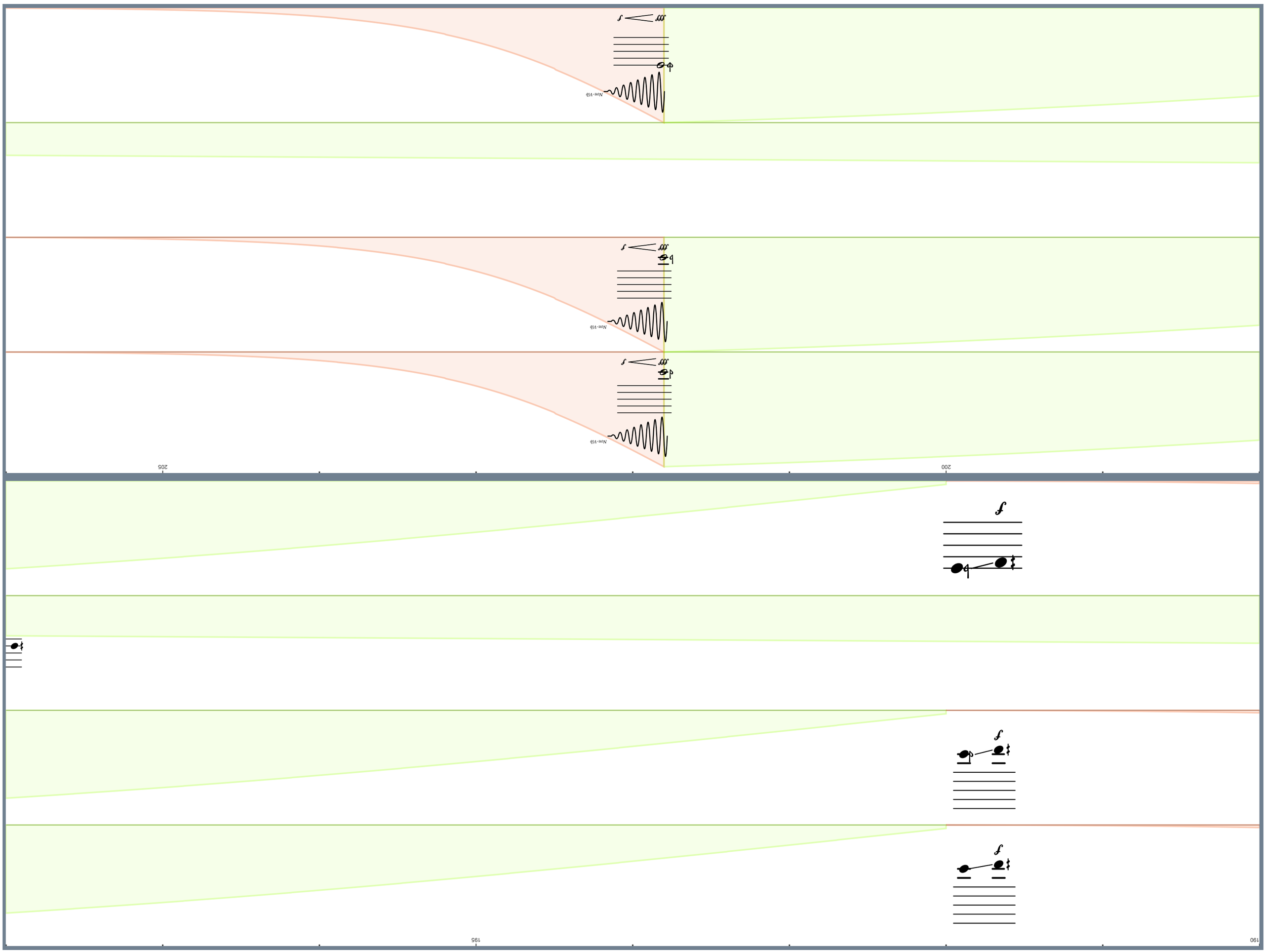
Non-Vib

f

fff f

Non-Vib

fff f


205
200
195
190
Non-Vib
Non-Vib
Non-Vib
fff
f
fff
f
fff
f
f
f
f

210

f

f

f

215

220

Non-Vib

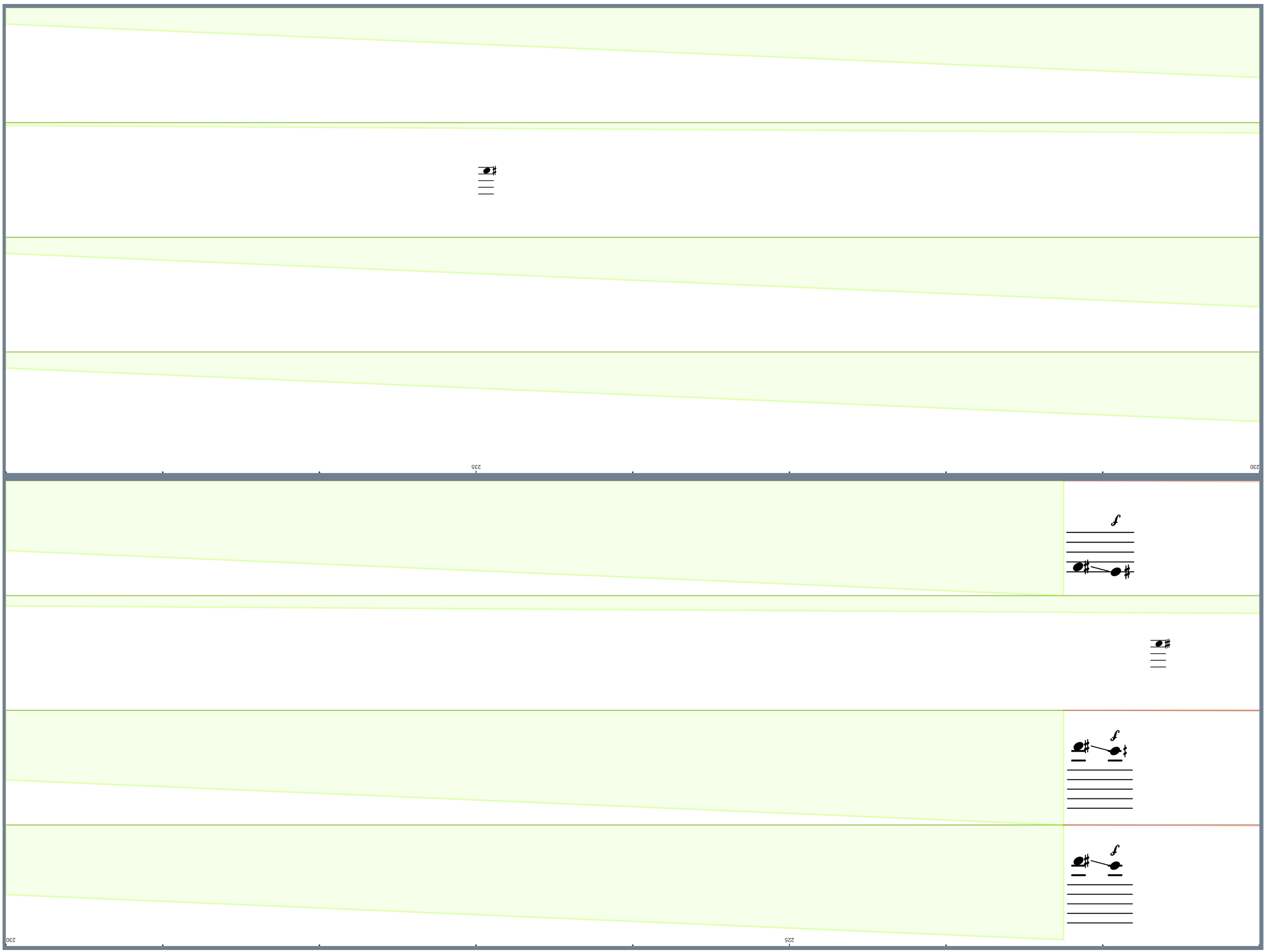
ff f

Non-Vib

ff f

Non-Vib

ff f


235
230
f
f
f
225
230

240

245

Non-Vib

ppp

fff secco

250

fff

pizz.

6:4

5:4

ff

pizz.

6:4

5:4

ff

Non-Vib

p

fff secco

pizz.

ff

255

260

pizz.

Non-Vib

p fff secco

Non-Vib

fff

Non-Vib

p fff secco

Non-Vib

p fff secco

Non-Vib

p fff secco

pizz. 5:4

ff sfz

fff

Non-Vib

p fff secco

fff

pizz.

ppp fff

265

270

pizz.

f

pizz.

f

pizz.

f

pizz.

f

fff

pizz.

f

pizz.

f

pizz. 5:4 6:4 5:4

ff sfz

pizz.

f

pizz.

f

270

275

Non-Vib

p fff secco

pizz.

f

Non-Vib

pp fff secco

Non-Vib

p fff secco

pizz.

f

Non-Vib

pp fff secco

Non-Vib

p fff secco

pizz.

f

Non-Vib

pp fff secco

Non-Vib

p fff secco

pizz.

f

Non-Vib

pp fff secco

280

285

pizz.

11:8

ff sfz

m.v.

pizz.

ff

fff

pizz.

b.b.

5:4

3:2

b.b.

b.b. b.b.

b.b.
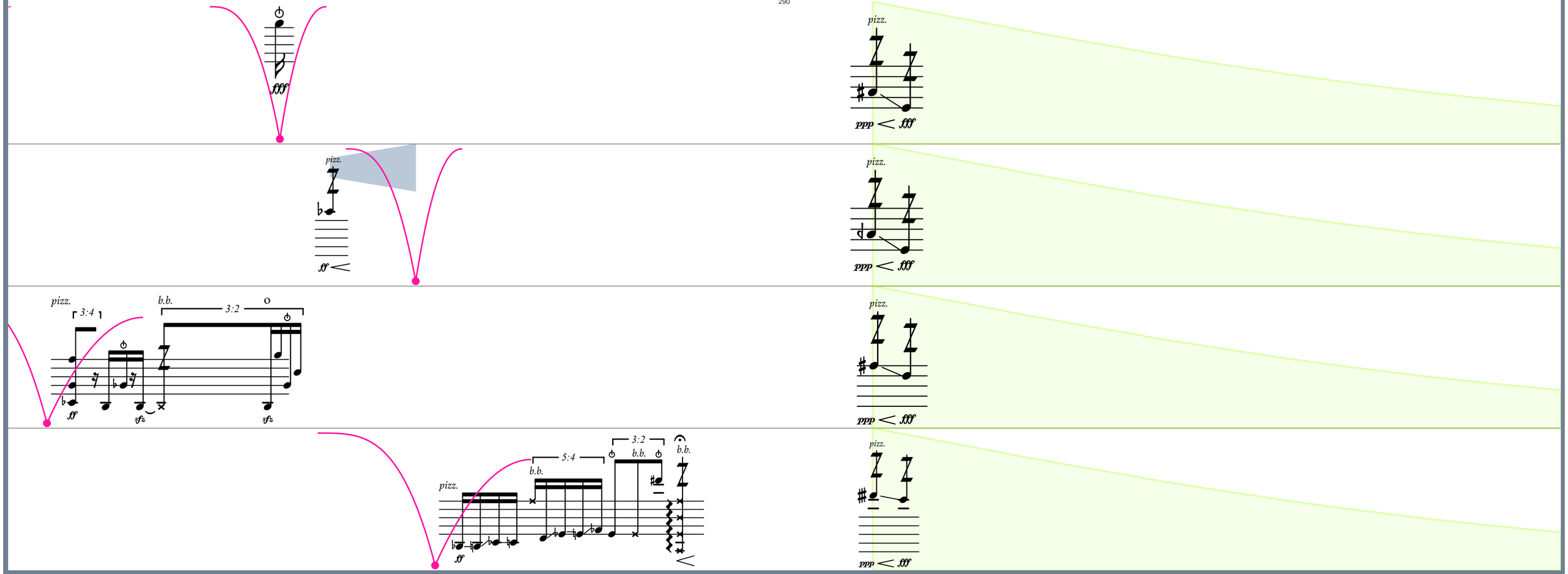
fff

pizz.

f

fff

290


fff
pizz.
ppp fff
pizz.
ff
pizz.
ppp fff
pizz.
3:4
b.b.
3:2
ff
sfz
sfz
pizz.
ppp fff
pizz.
3:2
b.b.
5:4
b.b.
b.b.
ff
pizz.
ppp fff

295

300


305
310
Non-Vib
mf
Non-Vib
mf
310
315
fff
fff
fff
fff
fff
Non-Vib
mp
f
fff
pizz.
ppp
f
fff
fff

320

325

Non-Vib

mf f

fff

Non-Vib

mf f

330

pizz.

ppp f

Non-Vib

mf f

fff

335

340

345

350

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib

f ff secco

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib

f

Non-Vib

f

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib

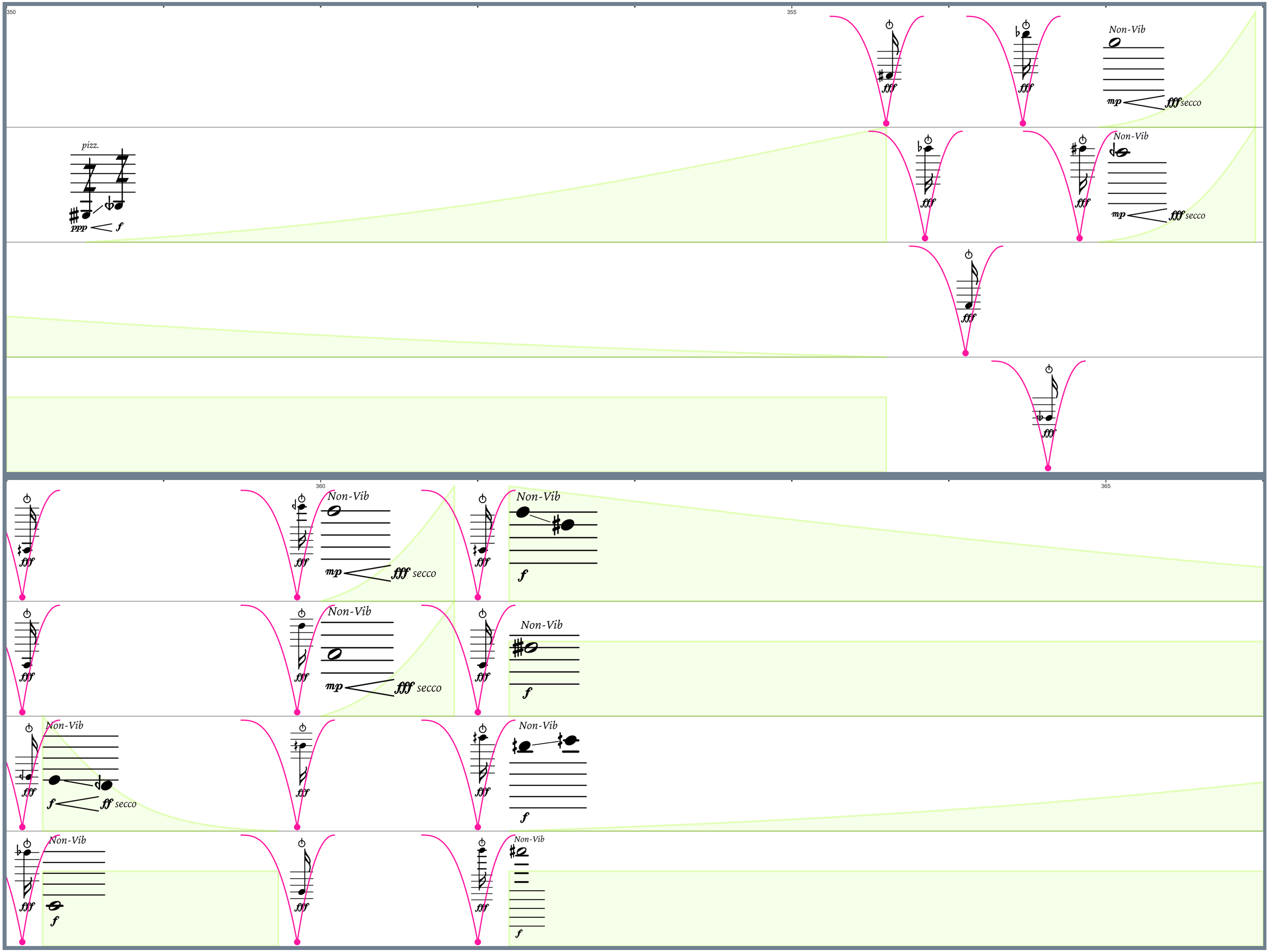
f fff secco

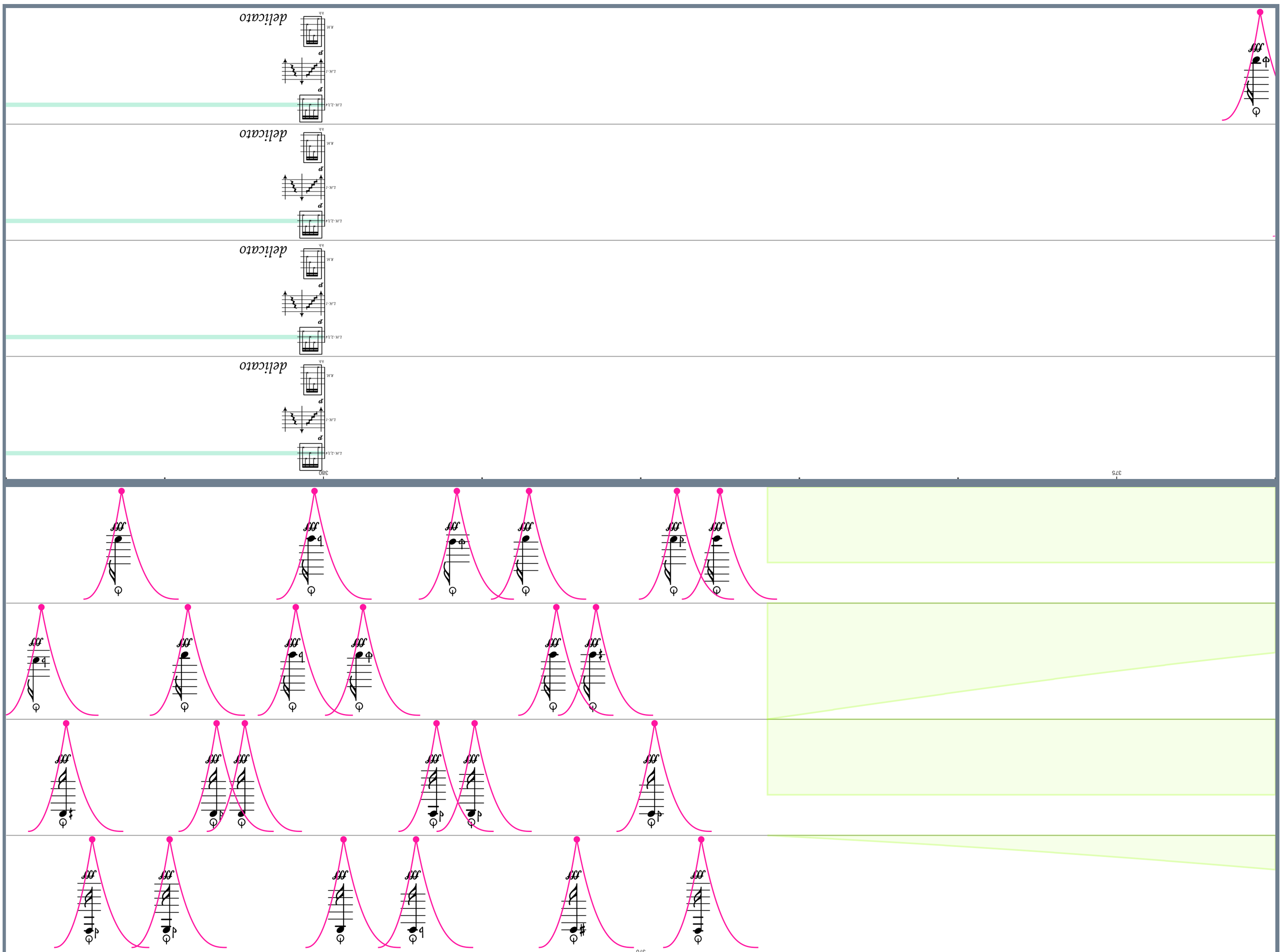
Non-Vib

f ff

Non-Vib

f

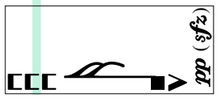

350
355
pizz.
ppp
f
Non-Vib
mp
fff secco
fff
360
365
ff secco

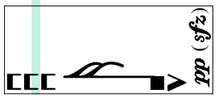

delicato
L.H.-2,3,4
L.H.-1
R.H.
delicato
L.H.-2,3,4
L.H.-1
R.H.
delicato
L.H.-2,3,4
L.H.-1
R.H.
delicato
L.H.-2,3,4
L.H.-1
R.H.
380
375
370

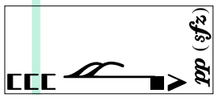
390

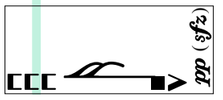
385

395

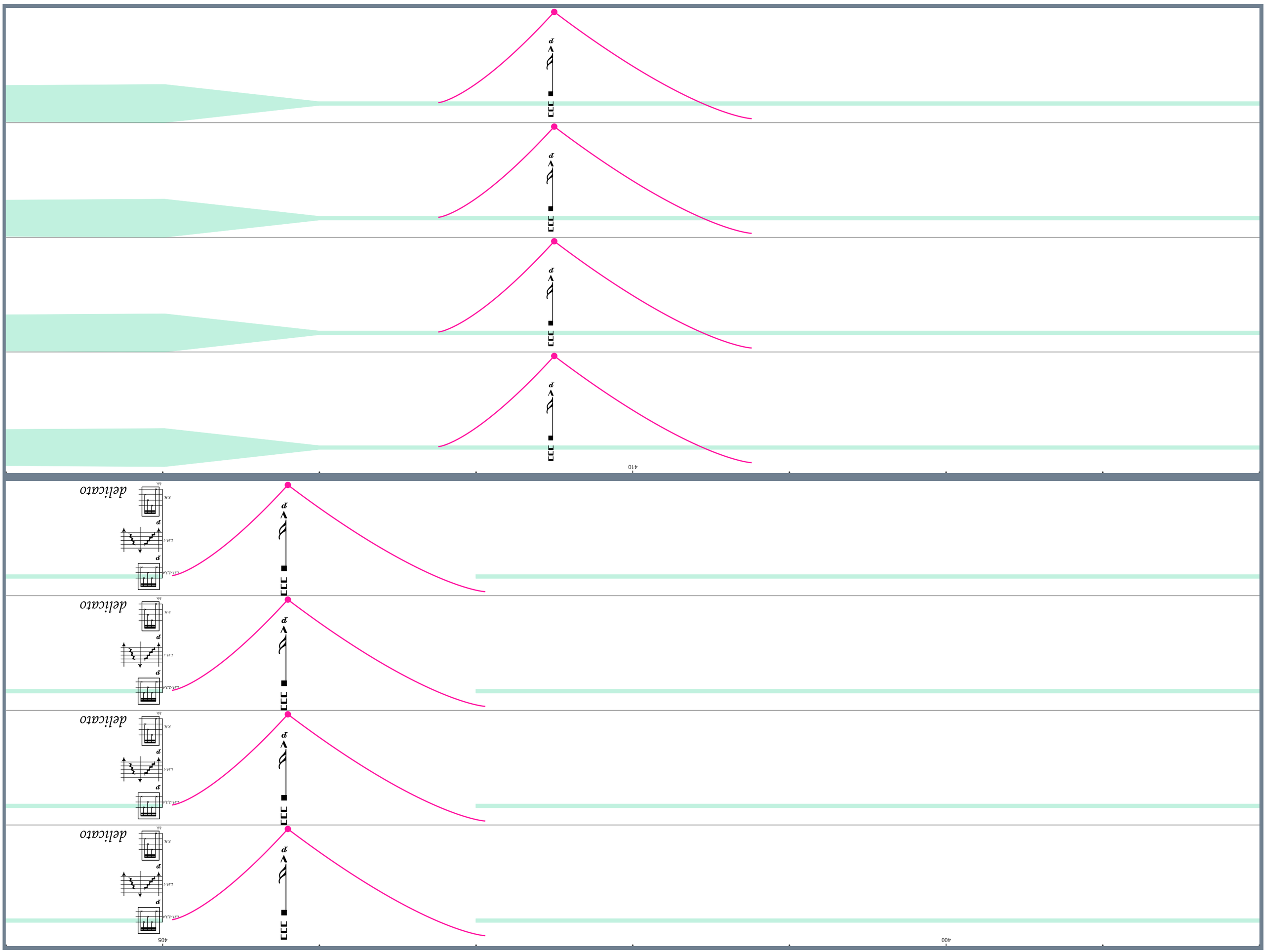


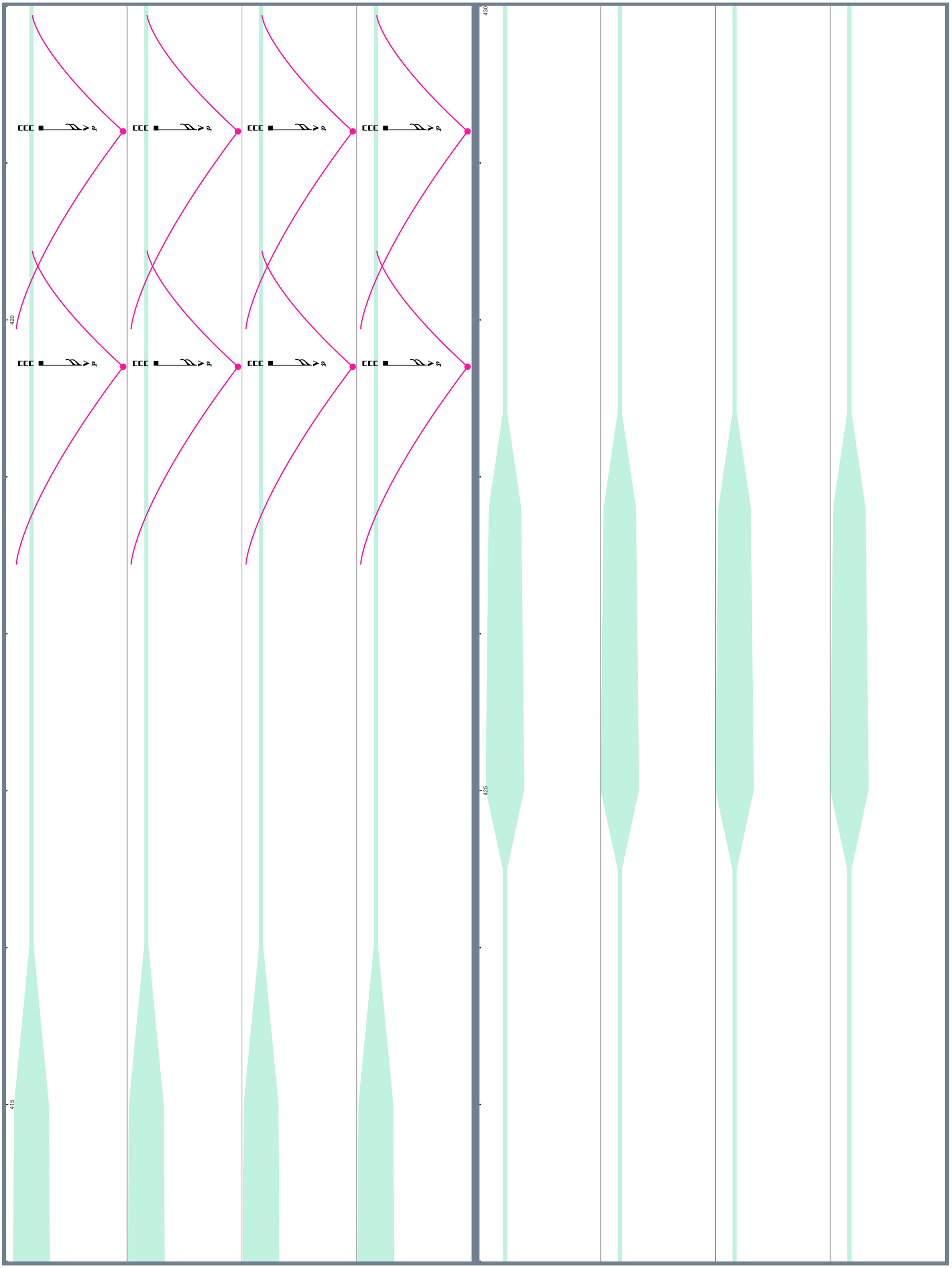


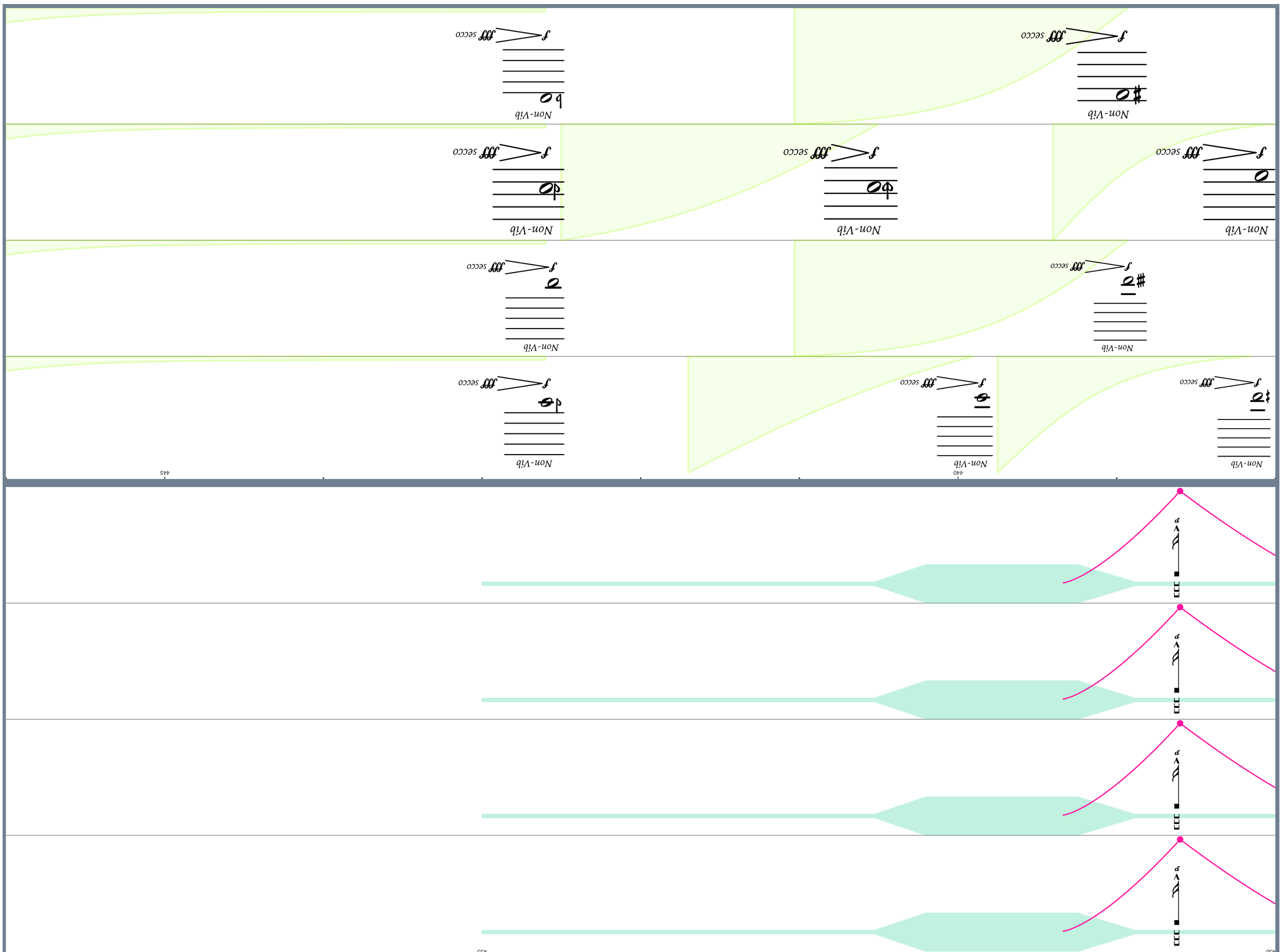




390


delicato
R.H.
L.H.-1
L.H.-2,3,4
p
410
405
400


420
415
430
425


Non-Vib
secco
Non-Vib
secco
Non-Vib
secco
Non-Vib
secco
Non-Vib
secco
Non-Vib
secco
Non-Vib
secco
Non-Vib
secco
445
440
435
430

450

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib

f fff secco

455

460

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib
f

Non-Vib
f

Non-Vib
f fff secco

Non-Vib
mp f secco

Non-Vib
mp f secco

Non-Vib
f fff secco

Non-Vib
mp f secco

Non-Vib
mp f secco

Non-Vib
f fff secco

Non-Vib
f fff se

Non-Vib
f

Non-Vib
f

Non-Vib
f fff secco

Non-Vib
f fff secco

Non-Vib
f fff secco

Non-Vib
f fff secco

Non-Vib
f fff secco

Non-Vib
f fff secco

Non-Vib

Non-Vib
f fff secco

Non-Vib
f fff secco

Non-Vib
f fff s

Non-Vib
f fff secco

Non-Vib
f fff secco

Non-Vib
f fff secco

480

485

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib

fff pp

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib.

fff ff

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib.

fff ff

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib

f fff secco

Non-Vib.

fff ff

490

Non-Vib.

ff f

Non-Vib

f pp

Non-Vib.

ff f

Non-Vib

f pp

Non-Vib.

ff f

Non-Vib

f pp


510
505
500
495